

LIVE

Learning Space

NEWSPAPER 29th OCTOBER, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

44th WEEK



SRI LANKA CRISIS ... AN OVERVIEW

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations



Learning Space

LIVE



NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

29th OCTOBER, 2018



Will Durant

“Civilisation begins with order, grows with liberty and dies with chaos”



POINTS TO PONDER !

2

- The present controversy in CBI is creating some sort of chaos in the central investigation organisation and this does not bore well for the democracy.
- The independence of the investigative organs is the hallmark of democracy.



THOUGHT
FOR THE
DAY

1

- Recent UGC's order says that the professors working in public universities should not criticise the Government policies.
- Critical appraisal is the corner-stone of the western universities. Without critical thinking, it is not possible to inculcate creativity and innovation.



MUMBAI UNIVERSITY

1

Avoidable crisis

President Sirisena's actions have put Sri Lankan democracy in peril

Sri Lankan President Maithripala Sirisena's decision to withdraw his faction from the ruling coalition and replace Prime Minister Ranil Wickremesinghe with former President Mahinda Rajapaksa has plunged the country into a political crisis. This was further complicated, a day later, by the President's move to suspend Parliament till November 16. Mr. Sirisena's fast deteriorating relationship with Mr. Wickremesinghe was an open secret, and there were indications that he could be negotiating a possible partnership with Mr. Rajapaksa. But his sudden and secret manoeuvre caught everyone, including senior politicians, completely unaware. And before the details and implications of the political drama that was unfolding could sink in, Mr. Rajapaksa had been sworn in Prime Minister, becoming as he greeted the President, his chief rival until days ago. Mr. Wickremesinghe has termed his replacement "unconstitutional" and maintained that he remains Prime Minister. Confident of a majority, he has challenged the Rajapaksa-Sirisena coalition to take a floor test in the 225-member House. By suspending Parliament, Mr. Sirisena is seen to have exposed his own insecurity about garnering the required strength. The next two weeks will be crucial, with attempts at horse-trading and assertions of political loyalty amid uncertainty. None of these is uncommon in Sri Lankan politics, but the circumstances, which are entirely of Mr. Sirisena's making, have led to a political upheaval that was avoidable. All this has come at a time of economic fragility, with a plummeting rupee, soaring unemployment and rising living costs.

Mr. Sirisena's appointment of Mr. Rajapaksa even before voting out Mr. Wickremesinghe on the floor of Parliament is nothing but blatant abuse of his executive powers. Guided by narrow political interests, the President's actions betray an utter disregard for the parliamentary process. In resorting to these emergency measures, he has not only put democracy in serious peril but also let down Sri Lankans, including a sizeable section of the Tamil and Muslim minorities that backed him in the critical 2015 election. The best forum to test political clout in a democracy is the legislature. An extra-parliamentary power struggle, that too using illegal means, heightens the risk of political futility and unrest. Still recovering from the violence and bloodbath during its nearly three-decade-long civil war, and grappling with the economic and social challenges in its aftermath, Sri Lanka cannot afford to recede from the democratic space that opened up in 2015. Mr. Sirisena and Mr. Wickremesinghe had come together in an exceptional political alliance that promised to put the country back on the path of democracy, after a decade of Mr. Rajapaksa's authoritarian rule. Leaving aside the irony of Mr. Sirisena joining hands with Mr. Rajapaksa, who he had left and subsequently unseated from office, his desire to consolidate power by hook or by crook is extremely unfortunate. Though much damage has been done already, a fair vote must be ensured when Parliament reconvenes, if possible before November 16.

THE HINDU
INDIA'S NATIONAL NEWSPAPER SINCE 1878

29th October, 2018

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UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... International Relations

India and its neighborhood- relations.



IMPORTANT DEVELOPMENT IN SRI LANKA

1

**MAITHRIPALA SIRISENA**

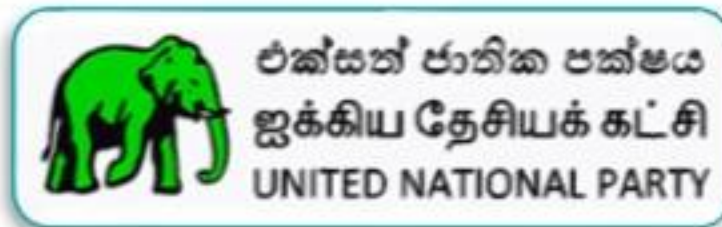
President, Sri Lanka
United People's Freedom Alliance



2

**RANIL WICKREMESINGHE**

Outgoing Prime Minister, Sri Lanka
United National Party



3

**MAHINDA RAJAPAKSA**

Former President, Sri Lanka,
Now the Prime Minister,
Sri Lanka Freedom Party





INDIA



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MYANMAR
(BURMA)

Lao PDR

THAILAND

Gulf of
Thailand

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal

SRI LANKA

OMAN

Gulf of Oman



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IMPORTANT DEVELOPMENT IN SRI LANKA

**MAITHRIPALA SIRISENA**

President, Sri Lanka

**MAHINDA RAJAPAKSA**Former President, Sri Lanka,
Now the Prime Minister**RANIL WICKREMESINGHE**

Outgoing Prime Minister, Sri Lanka

Both the leaders cited Article 42(4) of the Sri Lanka's Constitution to declare contradictory positions.

- 1 President Maithripala Sirisena pulled his faction out of Sri Lanka's ruling coalition.
- 2 He appointed former President Mahinda Rajapaksa as the Prime Minister.
- 3 It led to the collapse of the Country's first National Unity Government. That means, Sirisena once again joined hands with Mahinda Rajapaksa.
- 4 Ranil Wickremesinghe's United National Party maintained that Mr. Rajapaksa's appointment was "illegal and unconstitutional".

SUBSEQUENT DEVELOPMENTS



MAITHRIPALA SIRISENA
President, Sri Lanka



RANIL WICKREMESINGHE
Outgoing Prime Minister, Sri Lanka

- 1 The ousted Prime Minister Ranil Wickremesinghe asked for reconvening Parliament, so as to prove his majority.
- 2 Meanwhile, the President, Maithripala Sirisena suspended the Parliament.
- 3 Parliament was prorogued until 16th November.
- 4 Differences between Mr. Sirisena and Mr. Wickremesinghe are steadily escalating since April, when the President backed a no-confidence vote against his Prime Minister.

MAIN TRIGGERS!

- 1
 - Mr. Wickremesinghe, about a week ago, issued a strongly worded statement from New Delhi, after his meeting with Prime Minister Narendra Modi.
 - The statement targeted the President, almost holding him directly responsible for the delay in Indian projects in Sri Lanka



- 2 On October 25, Sri Lanka's Constitutional Council rejected two of Mr. Sirisena's nominees for vacancies at the Supreme Court and the Court of Appeal.



MAITHRIPALA SIRISENA
President, Sri Lanka

European Union and United States expressed concern over the manner in which the Sri Lankan President withdrew support to Prime Minister.

WHAT INDIA SAID FINALLY?



- 1 India reminded Sri Lanka of Constitutional process. As a democracy and a close friendly neighbor, India hopes that democratic values and constitutional process will be respected.
- 2 India will continue to extend developmental assistance to the friendly people of Sri Lanka.

HOW TO VIEW THIS?

**MAHINDA RAJAPAKSA**

Former President, Sri Lanka,
Now the Prime Minister



*The desire to consolidate power
by hook or by crook is extremely
unfortunate.*

- 1 The appointment of Mr. Rajapaksa is blatant abuse of the President's executive powers.
- 2 It is utter disregard for the Parliamentary process.
- 3 The best forum to test political clout in a democracy is the legislature.
- 4 Still recovering from the violence and bloodbath during the nearly three decade long civil war, Sri Lanka cannot afford to recede from the democratic space that opened up in 2015.

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SINCERE THANKS
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